



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Legacy Academy

School Website: <https://www.legacyacademyde.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Legacy Academy (Georgetown, DE, 19947) presents a clear classical Christian orientation across most dimensions of its public materials. Its public communications emphasize Christ-centered formation, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), memory-driven pedagogy (recitation and poetry from memory), and engagement with Latin and Shakespeare through camps and programs. The school frequently frames education as formation of character and virtue within a spiritual framework, and it maintains visible partnerships with families and a culture of community events (e.g., Open Houses, Grandparents Breakfast, pastors' and community gatherings). The most explicit gap relative to a fully classical rubric is in the explicit articulation of Socratic seminars and some traditionally schol   (restful, contemplative) pedagogical rhythms in core public materials; however, concrete evidence of traditional elements such as the Trivium, Great Books practices (as part of "Great Conversation" concepts) and a living-mission emphasis is present.

Overall classification (aggregate): **CLASSICAL**

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence includes explicit Christ-centered theology, integration of faith with learning, and liturgical/community rhythms mentioned in school materials. Positive signals far outweigh any negative signals (no clear secularization indicators found in the public material).
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL** The school emphasizes formation, virtue, and a transcendent sense of truth/goodness/beauty as guiding aims, not mere job prep. This aligns with a formation-first, humane-excellence orientation.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL** Strong evidence of Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Latin, and classical culture through camps (Latin Boot Camp, Shakespeare Camp). Great Books lineage and "Great Conversation" framing are implied by the classical-curriculum emphasis.
- **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence shows robust memory/recitation and chanting practices (e.g., Scripture, poetry recitation) and a strong emphasis on Christian formation; however, explicit, pervasive documentation of Socratic seminars (the high-school hallmark) is less evident in public pages. The presence of memory-based and liturgical/repetitive pedagogy is clear, but additional Socratic/dialectical pedagogy is not as prominently documented in the public-facing content.
- **Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL** The school presents teachers as mentors and models of virtue, with documented faculty profiles and explicit emphasis on teacher leadership and formation (e.g., individual faculty pages and biographical notes). This aligns with the classical ideal of teachers as living exemplars and part of the curriculum.

- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL The school foregrounds partnership with families and churches, parent engagement, and open campus/community events. Public materials portray parents as co-educators and active participants in school life.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence: explicit theology and liturgical rhythms; Christ-centered framing; integration of faith with curriculum. Positive keyword indicators far exceed negatives. Why CLASSICAL: theological grounding, liturgical/community practices, and transcendent aims are clearly signaled.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence: formation-centric language; virtue and wisdom as aims; transcendent truth/goodness/beauty. Positive keywords present (formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful). Why CLASSICAL: formation and higher goods over mere job prep.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Latin; Great Books/Great Conversation framing implied; Shakespeare and other Great Books-oriented programs. Positive keywords present (grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, Latin). Why CLASSICAL: strong canonical-curriculum signals.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: recitation/memory and liturgical-style pedagogy; Church- and memory-based learning signals; fewer explicit citations of Socratic seminars in public pages. Positive keywords present (recitation, memory, chant, dialogue-type practice in some form); negative signals minimal. Why SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: core methods align with tradition but high-Socratic pedagogy is not as evidently documented in public content.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: clear teacher profiles; biographies; living examples and mentors; faculty as core to school life. Positive keywords present (model teachers, mentors, living curriculum). Why CLASSICAL: strong portrayal of teachers as exemplar and core actors in education.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: explicit partnership language with families; parent engagement initiatives; open-campus events. Positive keywords present (partnership with families, parent formation, community events). Why CLASSICAL: explicit parent-co-teacher framing and active community involvement.

What Would Move the Needle

- For Element 4 (Pedagogy): To reach a fully Classical Pedagogy, increase explicit, explicit, and recurring documentation of Socratic seminars and dialectic work in the upper grades, and publish a public-facing articulation of scholé/restful learning rhythms within the curriculum. Concrete steps:
- Add a published section detailing high-school level Socratic seminars and seminars in logic and rhetoric.
- Include a public statement about Scholé, contemplative time, and rest in daily routines and syllabi.
- Provide sample lesson plans or syllabi that explicitly show Socratic dialogue, seminars, and formal debates in upper grades, alongside memory/recitation tracks.
- Expand Great Books exposure with explicit titles and reading sequences alongside discussion prompts to demonstrate the Great Conversation in daily teaching.
- Optional enhancements (general): Increase explicit references to Great Books and Great Conversation across grade bands, and publish a crosswalk linking memory work, recitation, and Latin/logic/rhetoric study to course outcomes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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